

"The Bill (on CM as chancellor of universities) has been sent back to her because it was incomplete information"

JAGDEEP DHANKHAR
Governor, West Bengal

"Judiciary is not a sacred card, We as a public have a right to question. Nupur has violated IPC, Zubair has not"

MAHUA MOITRA
TMC MP



tion like the Abrogation of Article 370 and CAA served no purpose. "See what happened to Kashmir. It's worse than before and the CAA Act has done no good," Khaleque quipped. But the panelists agreed that the more Parliament sits and debates the less bloodshed we will see on the streets. Even Sarangi concluded that the "majority runs the government but consensus runs the country and taking the nation forward has to be a collective responsibility".

If one thought the Nupur Sharma controversy was done and dusted, there was a mini dust storm waiting to stir fresh dissent in the auditorium, as sessions like "The Fine Line between Judicial Overreach and Executive Inaction" and "Revenge Politics: From Battle of Ballot to Battle of Bullet" took place. Panelists like Congress Rajya Sabha MP Abhishekh Manu Singhvi and former judge of the Supreme Court Asok Ganguly agreed that a climate of fear and hesitation has permeated the judiciary. "The fear of holding back promotions, appointments and transfers does have a role to play behind the hesitation," Singhvi argued. But it's time judges need to be true to their oath to uphold the Constitution. "The collegium apart, the judges ultimately have a conscience to answer, quieten and be accountable to," Singhvi added.

Former Union minister of Minority Affairs Mukhtar Abbas Naqvi said no one from the BJP has justified Nupur Sharma's remarks. Modi bashing is on with a vengeance, extending into Bharat bashing, he stated. "BJP has made no discrimination on development; there are three lakh masjids and another 3 lakh dargahs in India—numbers not even there in Pakistan."

Lok Sabha MP Mohua Moitra, an advocate of free speech, was caught in a controversy when asked for an opinion on a poster of a documentary showing Goddess Kali smoking a cigarette. Mahua said that to her, Goddess Kali is a meat-eating and alcohol accepting goddess, as it was customary to offer meat and wine to her puja. Her comment created a furore. The saffron brigade started trolling her, prompting her party Trinamool Congress to dissociate itself from it.

Another highlight of the conclave was the launch of India Today NE, a digital platform for the Northeast. India Today Group Vice-Chairperson Kalli Purie said: "Today I came to know this area is surrounded by five other countries. Strategically it's an important space. The eight states deserve more spotlight. With that in mind we are launching the latest in news venture, India Today North-East. Looking at this region we will showcase the area better and to a certain extent correct misunderstandings that exist about the region and its beautiful people."